INDIA TODAY
www.indiatoday.in

CHAIRMAN AND EDITOR-IN-CHIEF: Aroon Purie
VICE CHAIRPERSON AND EXECUTIVE EDITOR-IN-CHIEF: Kalli Purie
GROUP CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER: Dinesh Bhatia

GROUP EDITORIAL DIRECTOR: Raj Chengappa

CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER: Manoj Sharma

GROUP CREATIVE EDITOR: Nilanjan Das; **GROUP PHOTO EDITOR:** Bandeep Singh
EDITOR (FEATURES): Kai Jabir Friese
MANAGING EDITORS: Sunil Menon, S. Sahaya Ranjit; MUMBAI: M.G. Arun
EXECUTIVE EDITORS: Manisha Saroop, Kaushik Deka
SENIOR DEPUTY EDITORS: Sangram K. Parhi, Sasi Nair;
HYDERABAD: Amarnath K. Menon
DEPUTY EDITORS: Anilesh S. Mahajan, Pradip R. Sagar;
JAIPUR: Rohit Parihar; MUMBAI: Suhani Singh
SENIOR EDITORS: Sonali Acharjee, Ashish Mukherjee, Saikat Niyogi;
PATNA: Amitabh Srivastava
SENIOR ASSOCIATE EDITORS: Sonal Khetarpal; MUMBAI: Dhaval. S . Kulkarni;
AHMEDABAD: Jumana Shah; BHOPAL: Rahul Noronha
ASSOCIATE EDITOR: Avishek G. Dastidar, Vipul Grover; BENGALURU: Ajay Sukumaran
SPECIAL CORRESPONDENT: KOLKATA: Arkamoy Datta Majumdar
PRINCIPAL CORRESPONDENT: LUCKNOW: Avaneesh Mishra
PHOTO DEPARTMENT: Chandra Deep Kumar, Rajwant Singh Rawat (Deputy Chief Photographers), Arun Kumar (Principal Photographer);
MUMBAI: Mandar Suresh Deodhar (Chief Photographer)
PHOTO RESEARCHERS: Prabhakar Tiwari (Deputy Visual Research Editor),
Saloni Vaid (Chief Photo Researcher),
Jodha Singh Adhikari (Principal Photo Researcher)
CHIEF OF GRAPHICS: Tanmoy Chakraborty
ART DEPARTMENT: Sanjay Piplani (Creative Editor),
Angshuman De (Senior Art Director), Rajesh Kumar Angira, Bhoomesh Dutt Sharma (Associate Art Directors), Santosh Kumar Sharma (Assistant Art Director), Praveen Kumar Gummadi (Chief Designer),
Siddhant Jumde (Chief Illustrator)
PRODUCTION DEPARTMENT: Harish Agarwal (Chief of Production),
Naveen Gupta (Chief Coordinator)

CHIEF OPERATING OFFICER
Suparna Kumar

IMPACT TEAM
Senior General Managers: Jitendra Lad (West), Syed Naveed (Chennai)
General Manager: Arup Chaudhuri (Bangalore)

GROUP CHIEF MARKETING OFFICER: Vivek Malhotra

SALES AND OPERATIONS
Deepak Bhatt, National Head (Distribution)
Rajeev Gandhi, General Manager (North)
Yogesh Godhanlal Gautam, Regional Sales Manager (West)

INDIA TODAY GROUP

Volume 50-Number 34; For the week
August 19-25, 2025, published on every Friday

• Editorial/Corporate Office Living Media India Ltd., India Today Group Mediaplex, FC-8, Sector-16A, Film City, Noida - 201301; Phone: 0120-4807100 • Subscriptions: For assistance, contact, email: wecare@intoday.com; Phone / Whatsapp: +91 8597 778 778 (Monday to Saturday, 9.30am – 5.30pm). • Sales: Direct all trade enquiries to General Manager (Sales), Living Media India Limited, C-9, Sector-10, Noida-201301 (UP). • Regd. Office: F-26, First Floor, Connaught Place, New Delhi-110001. • Impact Offices: 1201, 12th Floor, Tower 2 A, One Indiabulls Centre, (Jupiter Mills), S.B. Marg, Lower Parel (West), Mumbai-400013; Phone: 022 69193355; Fax: 66063226 • E-1, Ground Floor, Videocon Towers, Jhandewalan Extn, New Delhi. • Door No: 610, 610A, 612, 5th Floor, Block A, Imperial Chaitanya Building, Anna Salai, Teynampet, Chennai, Tamilnadu-600018. • 201-204 Richmond Towers, 2nd Floor, 12, Richmond Road, Bangalore-560025; Phones: 22212448, 22213037, 22218343; Fax: 22218335; • 52, Jawaharlal Nehru Road, 4th Floor, Kolkata-700071; Phones: 22825398; Fax: 22827254; • 6-3-885/7/B, Somajiguda, Hyderabad-500082; Phone: 23401657, 23400479, 23410100, 23402481, 23410982, 23411498; Fax: 23403484 • 39/1045, Karakkatt Road, Kochi 682016; Phones: 2377057, 2377058 ; Fax: 2377059 • 2/C, "Suryarath Bldg", 2nd Floor, Behind White House, Panchwati, Office C.G. Road, Ahmedabad-380006; Phone: 26560393, 26560929; Fax: 26565293 • Copyright Living Media India Ltd. All rights reserved throughout the world. Reproduction in any manner is prohibited.

Printed and published by Manoj Sharma on behalf of Living Media India Limited. Printed at Thomson Press India Limited, 18-35 Milestone, Delhi Mathura Road, Faridabad-121007, (Haryana) and at Rajhans Enterprises, 134, Industrial Town, 4th Main Road, Rajajinagar, Bengaluru-560044, (Karnataka).

Published at F-26, First Floor, Connaught Place, New Delhi-110001.

Editor: Raj Chengappa.

• INDIA TODAY does not take the responsibility for returning unsolicited publication material.

All disputes are subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of competent courts and forums in Delhi/New Delhi only

SYNDICATIONS TODAY INDIA DELIVERED
For **reprint rights** and **syndication** enquiries, contact syndications@intoday.com or call +91-120-4078000
www.syndicationstoday.in

CONTENTS

UPFRONT: AFTERBURNER EFFECT OF OP. SINDOOR *PG 10*

STATE SCAN: NITISH'S TEMPLE TANGO IN BIHAR *PG 18*



MANDAR DEODHAR

30 COVER STORY

INFOTECH SECTOR

WHO MOVED MY JOB?

INDIA'S BIGGEST EMPLOYMENT GENERATOR SEES MASSIVE LAYOFFS, FORCING FIRMS TO RESET OR FACE OBSOLESCENCE

▶ ELECTORAL ROLLS

26 Rahul Ups the Ante

From "vote *chori*" allegations in Karnataka to Bihar's contested revisions, disputes over voter rolls deepen the crisis

▶ PUNJAB

39 No Mann's Land

The Punjab CM backs down, withdraws much-hyped land pooling policy after backlash from farmers and the HC

▶ GANESH IDOLS

42 Immersed in Uncertainty

The booming Ganesh idol industry faces ecological pushback over the use of PoP

▶ CHESS

46 It's Reigning Queens

Divya Deshmukh's feat demonstrates how far women's chess has come in India

▶ LEISURE **51 Rethinking History** Audrey Truschke's deep dive into 5,000 years of Indian history

Note to the reader From time to time, you will see pages titled 'An Impact Feature' or 'Focus' in INDIA TODAY. These are no different from advertisements, and the magazine's editorial staff is not involved in their creation in any way.

Cover by **NILANJAN DAS / AI**

INDIA TODAY GROUP

Readers are recommended to make appropriate enquiries before sending money, incurring expenses or entering into commitments in relation to any advertisement appearing in this publication. The India Today Group does not vouch for any claims made by the advertisers of products and services. The printer, publisher, editor-in-chief and the editor of the India Today Group publications shall not be held liable for any consequences in the event of such claims not being honoured by the advertisers.

SCAN HERE TO SUBSCRIBE

FOR SUBSCRIPTION ASSISTANCE, CONTACT:
email: wecare@intoday.com | Phone / Whatsapp: +91 8597 778 778
(Monday to Saturday, 9.30am – 5.30pm)

E-MAIL to:
letters.editor@intoday.com or
log on to **www.indiatoday.in**